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THE POLITIC

Spring 2011

NATIONAL

Inside Terrorism: Interview with National Security Expert Bruce Hoffman

INTERNATIONAL

Negative History: Interview & Photographs from Chinese Dissident Sze Tsung Leong

FEATURE

Redefining Arab Moderation: Interview with Fmr. Dep. Prime Minister of Jordan Marwan Muasher

ALSO—

NATIONAL
Wall Street Reform, Obama's Intellectual Development

FEATURE
Top Ambassadors & CIA Veterans on the Middle East Uprisings

INTERNATIONAL
The Mexican Drug War, Wikileaks, and Russia's Troubles

AND—
featuring a retrospective piece from Sen. John Kerry

THE YALE UNDERGRADUATE POLITICAL JOURNAL

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THE POLITIC

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DEAR READER,

Welcome to *The Politic*. We are excited to present our Spring 2011 issue, which incorporates a full-scale redesign of the magazine and, as always, delivers insightful commentary on a diverse range of pressing topics.

For those unfamiliar with us, *The Politic* traces its roots back to 1947 as Yale's leading undergraduate political journal. Past Editors-in-Chief include Brookings Institute Senior Fellow Robert Kagan '80, Editor of *Foreign Affairs* Gideon Rose '85 and Editor-at-Large of *Time* Fareed Zakaria '86. Over the past 64 years, we have interviewed presidents, congresspersons, ambassadors, mayors, leading journalists and academics, and top economists and legal scholars. Building on this tradition, we seek to provide assorted and nuanced commentary on political, economic and legal issues at home and across the globe, from the perspectives of both professionals and students.

The recent uprisings in the Middle East are on everyone's mind, and so we devote this issue's FEATURE Section to covering the unfolding events from a variety of angles. Over the last month, our staff has sat down and interviewed leading diplomat and former Jordanian Deputy Prime Minister Marwan Muasher, CIA veteran Paul Pillar, former Ambassador to Israel and Egypt Daniel Kurtzer, former NSC Director for Persian Gulf Affairs Kenneth Pollack and Turkish Professor of International Relations Veysel Ayhan.

The INTERNATIONAL Section spans multiple continents and formats. Inside, you will find a discussion with a Chinese dissident as he attempts to capture China's rapid development and historical ethos through photography, and student articles on the Mexican drug wars, newspaper coverage of the WikiLeaks scandal and the social and political climate of Russia as its Middle Eastern neighbors cope with revolution.

This relationship between past and future marks the NATIONAL Section. National security expert Bruce Hoffman reflects on terrorism, evaluating the United States' evolution of policy and the effect of the recent uprisings on the future of extremism. Additionally, legal scholar Michael Perino relates the financial reforms of the 1930s to the current economic crisis, while head of the Harvard history department James Kloppenberg explains the roots of Obama's worldview. Lastly, a retrospective piece from Senator John Kerry, originally published in *The Politic* 10 years ago this month, reminds us of the intractability of American energy problems in the 21ST century.

On behalf of our entire staff, we thank you for your interest in our journal and its coverage. If you are interested in conducting an interview with a leading policymaker or writing or soliciting an original article, please feel free to contact any of our editors. We also invite you to view our website at thepolitic.org.

We hope you enjoy this year's final issue, and *The Politic*'s exciting new layout.

SINCERELY,

Alexander Kayfetz-Gaum & Nick Rugoff
Editors-in-Chief

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INSIDE TERRORISM: AN INTERVIEW WITH BRUCE HOFFMAN

Conducted by
Nick Rugoff & Christopher Howell

Professor Bruce Hoffman is the Director of the Center for Peace and Security Studies at Georgetown. He previously held the Corporate Chair in Counterterrorism and Counterinsurgency at the RAND Corporation and was also Director of RAND's Washington, D.C. office. He was Scholar-in-Residence for Counterterrorism at the Central Intelligence Agency between 2004 and 2006, and is a member of the National Security Preparedness Group, the successor to the 9/11 Commission. He has conducted fieldwork on terrorism and insurgency in Afghanistan, Argentina, Colombia, India, Indonesia, Israel, Iraq, Northern Ireland, Pakistan, the Philippines, Palestine, Sri Lanka and Turkey. Professor Hoffman holds degrees in government, history and international relations, and received his doctorate from Oxford.

NR
How do the recent Middle East uprisings affect al-Qaeda?

BH
I think it's too soon to tell. Al-Qaeda, like foreign ministries and state departments across the world, is still assessing and taking in what is happening in the Middle East and North Africa and trying to fashion a response to rapidly unfolding events. I don't think they've quite divined what that response will be, but I don't think we should assume that just because they have been silent and don't seem to be taking an active part means that they're neither following it nor seeking to identify opportunities to assert themselves.

CH
In your book *Inside Terrorism*, you talk about the controversy and disagreement surrounding the definition of terrorism. Do you think we have come any closer to sufficiently defining terrorism?

BH
I stand by the definition that I had in the revised 2006 edition of the book: "the deliberate creation and exploitation of fear through violence, or the threat of violence, in pursuit of political change." But as far as the international community goes, I don't think we've come any closer. Unfortunately, I actually think we've moved backwards. This may be one of the unintended consequences of what has been called the 'War on Terror' rather than the 'War on Terrorism.' This is a misnomer because terror is an emotion, and the 'ism' in terrorism shows that it is inherently political, so we've already muddied it up. It's been seen now as either an assertion of American exceptionalism or even an assertion of partisan views within the United States. I think the entire 'War on Terror' has served to obfuscate rather than clarify any meaningful definition of terrorism.

NR
A 2008 panel found that a nuclear or biological attack on a major US city is likely to happen by 2013. Almost three years later, do you agree with their finding?

BH
No. I wouldn't say that it's likely, but one of the lessons from 9/11 is that when it comes to terrorism, you can never say anything is unlikely. Given the attrition of al-Qaeda's capabilities since 9/11, and particularly in recent years with the drone attacks, I would be very surprised if al-Qaeda could pull off a nuclear attack. A biological attack would be easier because you don't need to obtain fissile materials or trigger a nuclear explosion. I still think it's unlikely in the time frame of the next two years because when terrorist groups are weaker, they adhere even more closely to what they are comfortable and familiar with. As politically radical as they might be, they

want success and tend to become more operationally conservative. One of the problems since 9/11 is that we have to be able to cover the entire waterfront of potential terrorist threats. I think the likelihood of a nuclear or biological attack is much lower than a conventional attack such as a suicide attempt involving multiple bombers. But even though it is low, it is also neither inconceivable nor impossible to perpetrate.

CH
You mention suicide attacks—and there has been a significant increase in suicide bombings since 9/11. You state in your book that when compared with other forms of terrorism, suicide terrorism is significantly more effective at the tactical and operational level, but do you believe it achieves the strategic goals of the terrorist groups who utilize it?

BH
That's a very good question. It certainly achieves their tactical goals because it generates enormous fear in populations that often borders on panic. I don't think there is any tactical weapon besides WMD and suicide terrorism that inspires such emotional reactions. I don't think it advances a terrorist group's strategy, however, because their strategy is to cow us into submission and paralyze us with fear and inaction. That has hardly been the case when terrorists have used suicide attacks. Strategically, I think its success is more problematic, but it often definitely achieves the terrorism's fundamental tactical goals of fear and intimidation.

CH
Getting back to our earlier discussion, if a nuclear attack were to happen on United States' soil, would we have the capabilities to effectively respond to the fallout?

BH
I would say no, but I think almost every other country also lacks the ability to respond to a nuclear attack. Look at the July 7, 2005 attacks on the London subway system. London is a city well acquainted with terrorism, as it experienced decades of Irish Republican Army bombings and attacks from a wide range of groups such as radical Palestinian terrorist organizations. Just a few months before these 2005 bombings, the British had carried out a major international exercise called Operation Atlantic Blue. Despite all of this, the attack on the subways killed 52 people and injured over 700, and tremendously overwhelmed the emergency services and capabilities of London's hospitals. This is just one small dimension of what we would see in a nuclear attack. If we had to deal with unparalleled destruction, death and injury, not to mention the enormous incidence of radiation and radiological poisoning on the rest of the population, I am doubtful that any society could respond effectively in the immediate aftermath of a small nuclear attack.

If you go back to the Bali bombings in 2002, Australia, which has a great health system, did not have a hospital that could accommodate all the victims, who numbered in the low hundreds. Things have not really changed that much, and in the United States, we actually have fewer emergency rooms and fewer trauma-one level hospitals. Vice President Cheney used to talk about 1% threats, where even if there was just a 1% chance of a nuclear attack happening, we would have to jump on it right away to prevent it from happening. I think that is absolutely true and extremely relevant today.

NR
Scholars of terrorism frequently speak about the constantly evolving balance between liberty and security. Where does the United States stand today?

BH
I think we've done a very good job at balancing civil liberties while giving law enforcement and the intelligence community the tools they need to protect us. In doing so, we've learned that there has to be rigorous oversight in Congress and elsewhere, a vibrant press, an informed population and effective public interest groups to monitor these activities and hold public officials accountable. It's a constant process of calibration and recalibration depending on the threat level. We can always do better, but given that this is one of the most fundamental imperatives of any democracy, I think we've done well so far.

NR
If you could institute one policy into counter-terrorism practices, what would it be?

BR
I have two. First, I'd kill or capture Osama bin Laden. That act would have both the greatest short-term and long-term effects on al-Qaeda and the threat we face today. Since I'm not entirely certain that that will soon be achieved, in the interim, the other highest priority would be to strengthen our efforts in the non-kinetic realm. We need to continue to capture and kill terrorists, and we've been enormously successful in those respects, but we've been far less active and consequently much less successful in breaking the cycle of recruitment and regeneration by having an effective counter-radicalization program and public diplomacy and information operations strategy.

Terrorist organizations have sustained themselves because we have done extremely little to limit their ability to radicalize and recruit and attract new

supporters and adherents. For example, we give comparatively few resources to the Office of the Under Secretary of Counterterrorism at the State Department and the Office of the Under Secretary of State for Diplomacy. I think this is because the metrics for success are much harder to measure than simply capturing or killing terrorists. It is much harder to demonstrate that you've persuaded or prevented someone from becoming a terrorist. There doesn't have to be a balance in the distribution of these resources, but it is just as important to prevent the creation of a future terrorist, as it is to capture or kill an existing one. We are overwhelmingly focused on the tactical—that is, appropriately, the killing and capturing of terrorists—but do very little to strategically alter the balance of forces arrayed against us and prevent terrorist groups from successfully radicalizing and recruiting new generations of terrorists.

NR
How would you compare President Obama's counterterrorism efforts to President Bush's?

BH
They are virtually identical. We still have the same strategy overseas, where the military has the lead in countering terrorism. The predator and drone attacks have actually been increased under President Obama. President Bush reduced the population of Guantanamo, and despite an early optimism and good intentions to close Guantanamo, President Obama has come up against the same challenges that President Bush faced. President Obama has prudently continued many of the strengths from the Bush administration, but also many of the weaknesses of the previous administration have continued today. The failure in the non-kinetic realm that I just described, for instance, has continued. We still do too little to counter the terrorists' ability to spread their message to susceptible audiences.

NR
What is the American people's biggest misconception about terrorism or terrorist organizations?

BH
That this is a threat that will end or a war that can be won. It will never end, but I hope the threat can change so that the strategic challenge to the United States is reduced and terror attacks become far less frequent and consequential. The threat of terrorism is never going to end completely and I would argue that unfortunately, the United States is very much like Israel, which never talks about the end of the terrorist threat. I'm not saying we are like Israel in any political sense, but Israel lives in a constant state of alertness and readiness because there are people that wish it ill and seek to use terrorist tactics against it. We've had trouble accepting that since 9/11, we are in the same position, even though Israel is surrounded by hostile countries and we are not. Since 1968, the United States has been the top terrorist target every year for a variety of reasons including our superpower status, the presence of our military overseas (which has only increased) and the power of the American media (which can catapult a terrorist group from obscurity to prominence). As even more people now see the United States as invading other countries at will and imposing our way of life on them, it is likely that terrorist threats will continue to be a feature and concern of United States security.

CH
Do you think al-Qaeda is a cohesive organization or has it become genericized, where individuals not directly connected to the core leadership of the movement are now referring to themselves as al-Qaeda? Is al-Qaeda now the 'Kleenex' of terrorism?

BH
The word al-Qaeda itself means the base or the foundation, so it serves that purpose as an enabler, facilitator, recruiter and mouthpiece. That said, al-Qaeda still has a central command authority that plans and plots terrorist attacks. Terrorist groups often want to adopt the al-Qaeda name, and much of its longevity is due to its flexibility and malleability. That is nothing new, and stems from al-Qaeda's founding in 1988.

NR
You are one of the world's foremost experts on terrorism. What keeps you up at night?

BH
Our dependence on foreign oil keeps me up at night because it conditions a lot of our foreign policy responses and makes us vulnerable, both economically and in terms of our projection of power. This is a key factor that we have the power to change.

CH
What will you be working on in the upcoming months?

BH
I am in the process of writing a book that is a history of political violence and terrorism in Palestine during the period of British rule between 1917 and 1947. This era provides great insights to current counterterrorism policies and actions in the Middle East.

Protection vs. Production

Reprinted from *The Politic*, Spring 2001

The electricity crisis in California and soaring prices for heating oil, gasoline and natural gas across the country have brought our long-simmering national debate over energy policy to the boiling point. America has for decades imported, produced and consumed energy at a pace and in ways that are economically and environmentally unsustainable. A serious debate is long overdue.

The outcome should not be determined—as it has been too often in previous years—by a shortsighted false choice between human energy needs and development on one hand and conservation on the other. But the contest thus far seems to be leading down that well-worn dangerous path: President Bush is expected to press Congress for the authority to open some of America's last pristine wilderness to oil drilling.

Exploiting the Arctic National Wildlife Refuge in Alaska—among our greatest national treasures along with Yellowstone National Park and the Everglades—is now the centerpiece of the President's energy policy. The environmental risks of drilling in the refuge—nearly 20 million acres of pristine wilderness on the North Slope of Alaska—are extraordinary.

While the Refuge may seem too distant to warrant protection, one can only imagine that when Congress created Yellowstone National Park in 1872 it also seemed a distant, remote and inhospitable land in what was then America's far west. Today we realize how lucky we are to have protected that land. The Refuge is worthy of the same protection. It is the last five percent of Alaska's north slope not open to drilling—nothing like it exists anywhere else in the world. Peregrine falcons, endangered in the other 49 states, thrive there, and thousands of Porcupine caribou roam the Refuge, along with black, brown and polar bears, and grey wolves. We know the irreparable harm that drilling would bring to the refuge: oil companies already operating in Alaska's Trans-Alaskan Prudhoe Bay oil fields spill oil or other chemicals more than once a day and release more than twice the air pollution emitted in Washington, D.C.

Protecting—or exploiting—this refuge is, at its core, a test of whether this country has a conservationist ethic, and there is no room for error. When pristine wilderness is lost, it's lost forever.

While there are obvious environmental issues at stake and they are real, drilling in ANWR does not constitute sound energy policy. It gives false hopes to citizens suffering from real energy problems today and ignores the tough decisions this nation must make if we are ever to embrace a sustainable energy policy for the future.

The Administration promises that drilling in ANWR would increase oil supply by 1 million barrels each day and allow us to avert localized energy problems, like the wild price fluctuations in California's electricity market. This argument is muddled at best and cynical at worst. Not only is oil production in the Refuge nearly a decade away, but California generates less than one percent of its electricity from burning oil. Opening ANWR to drilling will do nothing to help Californians now or in the future. Moreover, there may be far less available oil below the Refuge than the peak production of 1 million barrels per day the

Administration predicts. Studies reveal that it may produce as little as 3,000,000 barrels per day, depending on reserves, price and other factors.

In the end, we could spoil the wilderness to satisfy our national oil demand for only six months.

The President further argues that opening the Refuge will reduce America's vulnerability to OPEC's market manipulation and lower overall energy prices. There is little evidence to support this argument. By 2015 the United States is expected to import more than 63% of its oil. Drilling in the Refuge would reduce that number by—at most—three percent, and leave OPEC with more market power than it has now and far more than it had during the oil crisis of the 1970s. Opening the Refuge will not stop OPEC from colluding to reduce global supply and drive prices higher—OPEC has achieved that exact goal with less market power in the past.

Drilling for oil in ANWR is no substitute for a sustainable energy policy—we should choose instead a course that alleviates immediate problems, conserves energy, supports renewable technologies and wisely maximizes our natural resources. This means immediate energy assistance for struggling families and stressed small businesses, helping to resolve regional problems and pressing OPEC and other exporting nations to increase global supply to a sustainable level.

Conservation is not deprivation if we properly harness technology. Increasing the efficiency of new buildings could save more than 1 million barrels of oil equivalent every day and boosting automobile efficiency by as little as 3 miles per gallon—well within the capabilities of automobile manufacturers today—would save 1 million barrels of oil each day. That's more than double the potential oil production of the Refuge, and it reduces dependence on fossil fuel, cuts air pollution and saves money. And unlike drilling in the Refuge, conversation has immediate benefits because energy savings can begin now and grow. Conservation should be backed by smart investments in renewable energy. Gains in solar, wind, geothermal, fuel cell, biomass and other renewable technologies will reduce our dependence on fossil fuels and truly insulate the nation from OPEC's market power. Finally, we must recognize that oil, gas and coal—together with these other sources—will be part of our energy mix for the future, and we should take steps to increase production in more appropriate areas and improve our energy infrastructure.

I believe in bipartisanship, but I also believe that sound economic and environmental practices are a matter of principle—which is why I have pledged to filibuster efforts to drill in the Arctic National Wildlife Refuge. A political standoff would no doubt showcase real differences over energy policy—but I'd rather see policy-makers showcase a common commitment to an approach that makes sense for the country. Several proposals already introduced and others under discussion have broad bipartisan support, and I hope President Bush will choose not to refight old battles and will instead join in a serious and thoughtful effort to meet this nation's energy challenges.

READING OBAMA: AN INTERVIEW WITH JAMES KLOPPENBERG

Conducted by
Nick Rugoff

James T. Kloppenberg is an American historian and the Chair of the Harvard history department, where he serves as the Charles Warren Professor of American History. Educated at Dartmouth (AB 1973) and Stanford (MA 1976, PhD 1980), he teaches courses on European and American thought, culture and politics from the ancient world to the present. His most recent book is *Reading Obama: Dreams, Hope, and the American Political Tradition.*

NR
Firstly, who is Barack Obama?

JK
He is not only a very skillful politician, but also a very well-educated and thoughtful student of American history and American political thought.

NR
What are the biggest misunderstandings that both the left and the right seem to have about Obama?

JK
I think the left projected onto him a set of radical plans that have no foundation either in the ideas he advanced in *The Audacity of Hope* or his 2008 presidential campaign. The right has misinterpreted the emergency measures made necessary by Bush's economic catastrophe as a radical departure from American democratic traditions when they would be better understood as the completion of a longstanding set of programs beginning with the New Deal and developing through later Democratic administrations.

NR
What is philosophical pragmatism? What makes Obama a 'philosophical pragmatist?'

JK
The early pragmatists—William James and John Dewey—directed their criticism against systems of philosophy (whether empiricist or idealist traditions) that claimed privileged knowledge of absolute truth. They argued that in many domains, experimental approaches were better than dogmatic proclamations of the truth. Obama shares that commitment to uncertainty and experimentation in politics.

NR
Who is the most surprising person that had an influence on Obama?

JK
I would say James Madison, who is typically unfairly characterized as a conservative thinker when he was the architect, as much as any other single individual, of the American democratic project. In his account of Madison in *The Audacity of Hope*, Obama shows awareness of Madison's creative role in the Constitutional Convention and his commitment to the democratic process of finding compromises and solutions to problems that would be impossible if people proved unwilling to compromise with each other.

NR
How has Michelle Obama shaped his worldview? Does she share his philosophy?

JK
It's hard to know based on his books, but his writings show a reverence for her and deep affection for her and her family that quite clearly, by his own estimation, left a powerful imprint on him. I think his admiration for her family's love for each other and her parents' commitment to their family and to their work impressed on him the importance of both a stable family and the crucial role played by the availability of employment.

NR
How does Obama differ from Bill Clinton?

JK
They are both very well educated and extremely intelligent people. I haven't seen a similar interest in American political thought in anything Clinton has written, so I think that's probably the distinction. I think they are both very deeply engaged in the process of electoral politics and have gifts, but different gifts. People have commented on Obama's more cerebral approach to politics and his more reserved personality as detrimental when compared to the more ebullient, outgoing good ol' boy son of Arkansas. I think those are simply differences and I don't know that one or the other is necessarily better suited to politics. I think the contrast between them is pretty apparent when you read their writings and compare them as presidents.

NR
With whom should we compare Obama?

JK
It's difficult to say because he's only two years into his first term, so I think at this stage, he is similar to many presidents who presented ambitious legislative proposals and had mixed results. That would include Woodrow Wilson and Franklin Roosevelt. To this historian, his ultimate legacy remains very much an open question and it is too early to assess after only two years.

NR
How did your views on Obama change when researching for your book?

JK
When I first encountered Obama, like most people on the left, I thought he was another moderate like Bill Clinton. It wasn't until I read *The Audacity of Hope* that I saw how ambitious his aspirations were and how sophisticated his understanding of the democratic process was. I think both his willingness to compromise and interest in identifying what is possible spring from a very sophisticated understanding of how democracies must function. I was not aware of that until I read both books. I think he's shown a tendency in his first two years to find the issues on which he can build coalitions. That ability or predilection for compromise has caused him to be pretty savagely criticized by a lot of my friends on the left, but it seems to me that they are misunderstanding him if they think he was once a radical and then became a moderate. I think he has been committed to coalition building his entire career and that his first two years demonstrate his commitment to getting things done rather than taking grandstand positions that cause his proposals to get shot down.

NR
How did Harvard Law School shape Obama, and how did his time on the Harvard Law Review reflect this?

JK
I think his experience at Harvard Law School was powerfully influenced by the importation into legal scholarship in the 1980s and 1990s of a whole range of ideas from American social theory. These included ideas from the history of science associated with Thomas Kuhn, ideas from cultural anthropology associated with Clifford Geertz, and the idea of civic republicanism in 18th century America, all of which transformed the way in which the legal academy understood ideas in general and the role of law in particular. I think that infusion of ideas from social theory shows up in a surprisingly large number of the articles that were published in the *Harvard Law Review* while Obama was in law school. For his last two years, he served on the editorial board, and his final year, he was what they call president, or what we could call editor-in-chief.

NR
How does he fit into the age of the sound bite?

JK
Very, very poorly *[laughter]*. Because he sees the complexity of issues and understands the necessity of taking into account different points of view and deep cultural differences among Americans, he is inclined to see the full range of views on any issue. That makes it very difficult for people to pigeonhole him because he doesn't think in simple thoughts, but in complex, nuanced thoughts. There's not much room for that in 21ST century American public life.

NR
Is there a particular time he would have been better suited for?

JK
He would have been much better suited to the late 18TH century, but as he knows as clearly as anybody else, there would have been no room for a mixed-race man in 18TH century American politics. I think he would have fit very nicely with the generation of John Adams, Thomas Jefferson, Benjamin Franklin and James Madison. While he is in some ways ill-suited to the politics of our day, the fact that he managed to get elected president shows that he is not quite as ill-suited to them as that characterization might suggest. He is more amphibious than we give him credit for. I think his natural environment might be the seminar room in a top tier law school like the University of Chicago, but as he demonstrated as an elected member of the Illinois State

Legislature and the United States Senate, and now as President of the United States, though he is not Bill Clinton, he can work a crowd and inspire people to get behind him. I imagine we will see more of Obama the campaigner in the coming years than we saw in the past two years.

NR
What should we expect to see over the next two years?

JK
That's a good question and one of the professional liabilities of being a historian—I don't think I have a better window on the future than anybody else does. I hope that we see a renewed commitment to the idea of economic equality that he discussed in his writings and in the 2008 campaign. I think I am among the many people who would like to see him take a stand opposing the extension of the Bush tax cuts as forcefully as he did in 2008. I would like to see him make good on his commitment to a critical evaluation of our military adventure in Afghanistan and begin withdrawing U.S. troops from that hopeless operation. I would like to see him reemerge as the champion of the ideas of a continuing progressive democratic project. As he heads into his reelection campaign, I think we are likely to see that Obama reemerge. That is what attracted me to him in his writings and I think we've seen glimmers of that. His performance during the health care debate was much more consistent with his record than some of his critics on the left have argued that it was. I think that if he restores the campaign for addressing the growing problem of economic inequality to his agenda, he can restore the confidence that many of his friends on the left had in him, without further antagonizing those on the right. I think he will be able to locate himself in a very old and venerable Democratic tradition of addressing problems of inequality, not by increasing the size of the federal bureaucracy as many conservatives fear, but by using the graduated income tax as the best mechanism for both increasing government revenues and addressing the problem of growing inequality.

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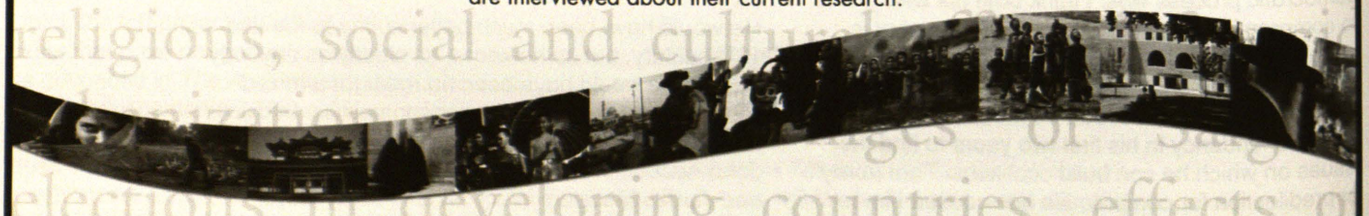

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THE HELLHOUND OF WALL STREET: AN INTERVIEW WITH MICHAEL PERINO

Conducted by
Nick Rugoff

Michael Perino is currently the Dean George W. Matheson Professor of Law at St. John's University School of Law in New York. He has also taught at Cornell Law School, Columbia Law School and Stanford Law School. He has testified in both the United States Senate and the House of Representatives, and is frequently quoted in the media on securities and corporate matters. Professor Perino received his LLM degree from Columbia Law School, where he was valedictorian, and his JD from Boston College Law School, where he was elected to the Order of the Coif. His latest book is *The Hellhound of Wall Street: How Ferdinand Pecora's Investigation of the Great Crash Forever Challenged American Finance.*

NR
Firstly, who was Ferdinand Pecora? What was his background and why did you choose to write a book on him?

MP
Pecora was an Italian immigrant who came to this country in 1886 at the age of five. He was a poor kid from New York who became a lawyer, and eventually a well-respected prosecutor who was plucked from relative obscurity to take over the faltering national investigation of Wall Street in the years following the Great Crash of 1929. Pecora took over in the investigation's waning days, and no one expected very much from him, but he really galvanized both the investigation and the country's appetite for reform. By revealing massive wrongdoing at the most well respected firms on Wall Street, he created the political climate in which Roosevelt was able to push through financial reforms.

NR
As a Sicilian born immigrant, Pecora would be considered an outsider in 1930s America. How did this affect the proceedings?

MP
At that time, many people still believed in stereotypes that held that Italian-Americans were lawless, anarchic criminals. The irony of this purportedly lawless Sicilian showing the lawlessness of the Anglo-Saxons who ruled Wall Street at the time was lost on nobody. Pecora became something of a media sensation and was on the cover of both *Time* and *Newsweek* in the same week in June 1933. The reports of his investigations were on the front pages of newspapers across the country, and there were puff pieces written about how he liked to play golf and take late night ice cream breaks—the kinds of things you'd normally have for movie stars. I think part of the public fascination with him is due to the fact that he was such a gifted and talented lawyer who didn't fit into any of the Italian-American stereotypes.

NR
What was the most fascinating thing that you discovered in your research?

MP
The most fascinating thing I found was that what we know as the 'Pecora Hearings' almost never happened. It was really through serendipitous luck that Pecora was chosen as the counsel for this investigation. His ability to create such sensational headlines was so crucial and that he almost was not chosen is a lesson in the contingencies of history.

NR
Why was Pecora so successful at harnessing popular outrage?

MP
Firstly, he was a fantastic lawyer. He had spent twelve years as a prosecutor in New York and knew

how to handle courtrooms and how to deal with witnesses. He was a first-rate crossexaminer with a memory that allowed him to remember every aspect of someone's testimony and every piece of evidence. If someone tried to weasel out of an answer, Pecora was right there to pin him down. It didn't matter who the witness was—Pecora was not someone who was willing to take it easy on the rich and powerful. When J.P. Morgan appeared before the committee, he complained that Pecora treated him like a common horse thief—and, to a certain degree, he did. Pecora knew how to ask questions and would become incredibly well-prepared by spending countless hours reading memos and briefing documents, in order to know answers to questions before he even asked them. His skill as a lawyer was just phenomenal.

He was also a great teacher. When you look at this investigation, you see that he was dealing with arcane financial concepts, but Pecora was able to present them in a manner that people could understand. He crystallized complex issues into these simple morality tales. By doing that, he was able to win public support for reform. Now, he had a receptive audience since there were not a lot of fans of Wall Street at the time, but it was really his skill and ability to galvanize support that led to many of the New Deal financial reforms.

NR
Both the 1929 and 2008 crashes seemed to share a series of flawed incentives, corruption and an overall lack of regulation. While the 1929 crash brought calls for greater reforms and more government regulation, it seems that the most vocal outrage after the recent crisis largely comes from the Tea Party, which is calling for fewer reforms and regulations. Why do you think the contemporary response to a major crash has been so different?

MP
I think the different responses are a function of both how and when the investigation was conducted. In terms of how, Pecora conducted a very different investigation than the recently completed Financial Crisis Inquiry Commission (FCIC). There was a key moment that illustrates the difference between the investigations that occurred during the FCIC investigation when one of the commissioners stated that he didn't want to get lost in individual stories, and instead wanted to focus on broad economic forces. That was the exact opposite of what Pecora wanted to do. As I suggested earlier, Pecora's real goal was to illustrate to people in a simple and easy to understand way why more reform was necessary. Rather than pouring through reams of data and talking about hypothetical conflicts of interest, Pecora would pick apart a single transaction and show how one set of bankers ripped off one set of clients in that transaction. He knew that this would be the easiest way to show why more reform was needed. So part of the difference comes from how the two investigations were conducted.

The other part is when it was conducted. Pecora took over these hearings in the winter of 1933, in the waning days of the Hoover administration. It had been over four years since the 1929 crash, and we were in the depths of the Great Depression. There was over 25% unemployment and people had lost their life savings from the thousands of bank failures across the country. Just as Pecora is really getting started, just as he is about to put on the stand the most famous banker of the time—Charles Mitchell, the chairman of National City Bank, which is now Citigroup—is when the 1933 Banking Crisis hits. By the time Mitchell leaves the stand, 38 states had shut down their banks entirely, and in the remaining 10 states, you could only get out 5–10% of your money at any given time. So, the juxtaposition of the wrongdoing that Pecora showed at National City Bank against the unfolding crisis in the banking sector really helped create the environment for reform legislation to pass.

To get the equivalent of what Pecora had in 1933, you would have to take those Goldman Sachs hearings in spring 2010 and move them back to the fall of 2008, when Lehman Brothers had collapsed, we were bailing out AIG, and the whole financial structure seemed to be disintegrating before everyone's eyes.

NR
How responsible was Pecora for some of the major financial reforms of the 1930s?

MP
I think he was extremely responsible. If you look at the people who drafted the New Deal laws, they point directly to Pecora and claim to have built on his work. None of that legislation would have passed if Pecora had not built political climate. For example, the Glass-Steagall Act, which among other things separated commercial and investment banking, and created federal deposit insurance. When Glass-Steagall was originally proposed, Louisiana Senator Huey Long led an effort that defeated it through a filibuster. Glass-Steagall was not going to pass and this was just a few weeks before Pecora took over the investigation. Once Pecora took over and began to show some of the wrongdoing at the elite firms on Wall Street, the political climate completely changed and an even more radical Glass-Steagall Act sailed through Congress with limited trouble. The original bill that was killed in January 1933 did not have federal deposit insurance, which had already been

proposed in hundreds of earlier bills and had always been defeated. In the wake of the Pecora hearings, Congress finally passed federal deposit insurance, which may be the most important banking reform to emerge from the New Deal. Pecora does not deserve all the credit, but he certainly deserves a large share.

NR
Is there anyone who could be considered a modern day Pecora?

MP
I haven't seen him or her yet. No one has really stepped forward to assume that role. I think part of the problem is that even if you had someone today who had Pecora's skills and abilities as a lawyer, the political window has closed. The sense of crisis that you need in order to overcome the normal political forces against reform legislation has already passed. The window of opportunity is gone for a modern day Pecora.

NR
How would you rate the current efforts at financial reform?

MP
I think much of the reform and effects are still unknown as much of the Dodd-Frank legislation delegates authority to the regulators to draft regulations. So, the real issue now concerns what those regulations will look like. We don't know the answer yet and the jury is still out on what financial reform will look like. I think the other big issue concerns whether we will give regulators the resources they need to actually enforce the laws. There's a big debate in Congress right now about the budget. The SEC and the Commodity Futures Trading Commission are unusual among financial regulators because they rely on the annual appropriations process. Some people in Congress, under the guise of 'we need to tighten our belts here,' are talking about substantially slashing the budgets of our financial regulators. That's a recipe for disaster. If we don't give the regulators the resources that they need in order to enforce those laws, then why bother having those laws in the first place?

NR
If you could see one reform instituted, what would it be?

MP
There was a proposal in Dodd-Frank that got killed, but would have allowed the SEC to fund itself from its own fees. The SEC is unusual in another way, since it is a net moneymaker for the government. Each year, it contributes more to the treasury than it gets in budget allocations. If you let the SEC fund itself through its own fees, then they would have plenty of resources to perform the functions that we ask them to perform. That self-funding mechanism was an early part of Dodd-Frank, but Congress decided it didn't want to lose control over the purse strings and eliminated it from the final bill. If I could do anything, I would put that provision in place.

MEXICO'S LAST STAND

DAVID A. PEREZ

Security forces scramble to react to an eruption of violence that kills 85 people in one day. Later, a mass grave is uncovered in the desert, revealing 72 mangled bodies. In a separate incident, gunmen ambush the police, executing 15 officers. This chaos is not occurring in Iraq or Afghanistan – it is happening on America's southern border with Mexico, a country that has been teetering on the brink of disaster since 2006, when President Felipe Calderón decided to launch a full-scale offensive against the country's drug cartels. Initially conceived as only part of a larger anti-corruption effort in the wake of his disputed victory in the presidential elections, Calderón has since found that dismantling the drug cartel network is a far more gargantuan task than he originally anticipated.

Now entering its fifth year, the conflict has claimed over 35,000 lives, which is about five times more than America's total fatalities in both Iraq and Afghanistan combined. And yet, despite all the bloodshed there is still no end in sight: 2010 was the bloodiest year to date, with over 15,000 drug-related deaths, a 58% increase from 2009. But at this point, the numbers themselves fail to tell the whole story. The violence itself has reached an almost theatrical level of absurdity that would make Quentin Tarantino blush. Imagine, five decapitated heads rolling onto a dance floor, or twelve armored SUVs storming a funeral to execute the father of the deceased. And it gets worse. Just recently, Secretary of Homeland Security Janet Napolitano suggested that a worst-case scenario now includes a possible partnership between Al Qaeda and a Mexican drug cartel. Clearly, something must be done to stem the violence, rein in the drug cartels, and regain a sense of normalcy for Mexico.

WAR ON WHAT?

Calderón insists that Mexico is doing all it can, and that the United States is doing too little, especially since the cartels are armed and funded with weapons and dollars from the United States. In a 5,000-word essay published last year, Calderón argued that the origin of Mexico's crisis "begins with the fact that Mexico is located next to the country that has the highest levels of drug consumption in the world."

During Calderón's recent visit to the White House, President Obama acknowledged that the war Mexico is fighting is both countries' war, and that the United States shares blame. Indeed, the U.S. has already committed $1.6 billion in material support and training for Mexico's counternarcotics efforts as part of the Merida Initiative.

Nevertheless, Calderón continues to blame the United States, who he considers "the biggest drug addict in the world," for Mexico's woes. Lines like these play well for Calderón's domestic constituency, but they don't tell the full story. Admittedly, it does not help that the United State is the world's biggest market for narcotics or that the drug cartels are arming themselves at American gun shops. The United States certainly needs to address those problems, but that is only half the story.

I've argued elsewhere that the real culprit is not America's addiction to drugs, but rather Mexico's addiction to criminal impunity. Drugs are only part of the problem. Corruption and bribery are rampant, while violent crimes like rape and murder simply go unsolved. And now, with many police departments tainted by the scourge of drug money, Mexico's military has had to step in to fill the void.

According to State Department cables, leaked to the press by WikiLeaks, the United States has become increasingly concerned with the army's performance. One cable points out there is 'considerable basis' to many of the human-rights claims that have been filed against the army, which include kidnappings, torture, and illegal raids. The Mexican government has acknowledged that some abuses have occurred, but claim that they are isolated incidents.

Nevertheless, these harsh tactics are leading some to question who exactly the military is targeting, and whether it was wise to deploy the armed forces in the first place. For instance, one State Department cable describes the military as "ill-equipped for a domestic policing role." And in the most damning assessment, one cable states flatly that the

military doesn't stand a chance: "The DTOs [drug trafficking organizations] are sophisticated players: they can wait out a military deployment; they have an almost unlimited human resource pool to draw from in the marginalized neighborhoods; and they can fan complaints about human rights violations to undermine any progress the military might make with hearts and minds."

Making matters worse, the military is not imbued with the power to actually participate in the judicial system as a police officer would to facilitate an investigation and prosecution. This is because the military does not have the authority to collect and introduce evidence into the judicial system. As a result, arrests have skyrocketed—with military detainments leading the way—but notably, prosecutions have remained flat. For instance, only two percent of those arrested in Ciudad Juarez are ever brought to trial. The rest either languish in jail or are set free.

Many critics now question the logic behind Calderón's decision to wage a war on drugs without first reforming a bankrupt criminal justice system that everyone agrees was (and still is) unprepared to process the growing bevy of drug arrests. In retrospect, perhaps Calderón should have focused first on passing and implementing judicial reforms to update the country's sclerotic and outdated criminal justice system, before placing so much stress on a system that was bound to buckle under such intense pressure. How do you win a war against criminals without a functioning criminal justice system? President Calderón seems to agree the fight is no longer solely about drugs, but about the state of lawlessness that pervades Mexico. For Mexico to stop now, he says, would be tantamount to allowing criminal kingpins to live with impunity. But for Calderón, time is running out.

NOW OR NEVER

Mexico cannot continue fighting an open-ended war against drug cartels. The military cannot continue serving as a domestic police force. The Mexican people cannot continue living under siege. At some point Mexico will have to win this war or concede defeat. The day of reckoning is fast approaching.

While President Calderón remains steadfast that victory is possible, and that Mexico's army can defeat the cartels by the end of his term in 2012, the U.S. government is not so sure. According to one State Department cable, a top Mexican official offered a sober assessment of his country's chances: "We have 18 months," he said, "and if we do not produce a tangible success that is recognizable to the Mexican people, it will be difficult to sustain the confrontation into the next administration." That cable was filed 17 months ago. Ending the conflict will seem especially attractive if Mexico's dismal fiscal outlook doesn't improve, given how costly the operations against the drug cartels have been. Mexico is already heavily reliant on quickly diminishing oil revenues and outside sources to fund its basic environmental and social services. Simply put, Mexico cannot afford to pay for another six years of this drug war. It would go bankrupt.

Mexico will elect a new president in 2012. Facing mounting pressure to change course, Calderón's successor may choose to cut his losses, scale back the anti-drug offensive, and try to return the country to its pre-2006 days. That would be a mistake. If Mexico cannot defeat the drug cartels, rein in the violence, and retake its streets, the brutal violence and crime sweeping across the country will continue to cross the border into the United States.

The drug cartels have already made Phoenix the kidnapping capital of the world (second only to Mexico City). In many ways, this conflict is very different than America's wars overseas. While reasonable people can disagree about whether the United States should scale back its presence in Afghanistan or Iraq, the stakes are arguably higher for Calderón (and America). If Calderón pulled back now, Mexico would be ceding huge swaths of its own territory to heavily armed militants bent on smuggling narcotics into America. Simply put, this is not a war of choice. It is a war of last resort.

So far, the Mexican public has supported the efforts. But that may change if exhaustion and hopelessness begin to set in. It certainly doesn't help that of the many thousands of allegations filed against the military for human rights abuses, only one soldier has been sentenced. By running roughshod over human rights while conducting an already controversial war, Calderón's government risks alienating those who are bearing the brunt of the violence: average Mexican citizens. These citizens will be less likely to support a continuation of Calderón's strategy during the next presidential administration if extending the program means another six years of military impunity amidst thousands of human rights violations and an increasingly severe fiscal crisis.

At some point Mexicans are going to ask themselves whether they would rather live in a pre-2006 world, where drug traffickers moved freely through their country, but violence was relatively low; or a future of near-constant violence where innocent Mexicans are caught between heinous drug traffickers on one side and brutal military operations on the other.

The clock's ticking.

IS RUSSIA NEXT?

Hanna Thoburn

The ongoing protest movements in the Middle East have brought new attention to the nature of Russian rule and the status of Russian civil society. Commentators and observers alike have wondered aloud whether the anti-authoritarian wave that has deposed Egypt's Hosni Mubarak and Tunisia's President Zine El Abidine Ben Ali, while challenging the power of Syrian, Libyan, Bahraini, Yemeni and Iranian rulers, will crest before reaching the former Soviet Union.

Like Arab states, former Soviet states are economically stagnant, corrupt and ruled by kleptocratic regimes that possess a certain penchant for controlling and oppressing their citizens: Economic conditions in the Russian provinces are not improving; political choice is negligible; fraud, graft and criminality remain rampant. Despite President Dmitry Medvedev's stated desire to root out corruption in Russia, he was forced to admit last summer that his administration had made no progress in the matter. In 2009, Transparency International ranked Russia 146TH in their Corruption Perceptions Index; in 2010 they fell to 154TH, worse than Tunisia (59), Egypt (98), Syria (127) and Libya (146). In response to the costs they incur from this corruption as well as to worsening international economic conditions, the businesses that provide necessary investment in Russia's economy have begun to flee. William Browder, the founder of London-based Hermitage Capital Management and major investor in the Russian economy, has been vocal about the massive fraud he alleges was enacted against his company; his warnings about Russia's criminal business atmosphere have certainly given investors pause. Locked in a battle with authorities over building and operating permits, Swedish furniture giant IKEA froze its Russian expansion in 2009. Not long after, international retailers Wal-Mart and Carrefour pulled out of Russia. The growth of foreign divestment from Russia bodes well for neither its economic diversification nor its future; its reliance on revenues from the sale of oil and gas cannot and will not last forever.

Increasingly, signs that ordinary Russians are fed up with their system have begun to appear. No longer appeased by the economic boom years of the 1990s and 2000s, some Russians have begun to take a closer look at their system and to call, in increasingly creative ways, for reform. One such example can be seen in a popular response to the special driving privileges Russian government officials enjoy and often abuse. In 2010, incensed at the incessant blaring of the blue sirens that top these officials' speeding cars, ordinary Muscovites began to affix blue buckets to the top of theirs—drawing attention as much to the driving abuses of top officials and as to Russia's systemic corruption.

At a nationally televised awards dinner in late 2010, television presenter Leonid Parfyenov spoke out boldly and forcefully against the near-total state control of Russian media, saying it is impossible for a journalist to be an objective reporter when "high policy makers are not newsmakers, but the bosses of his own superiors." "On federal television," he continued, "you will not hear any critical, skeptical or ironic statements" about public figures. "They have silenced up to a quarter of the spectrum of public opinion. The high authorities are like the dearly departed: say about them only good or say nothing at all." His remarks came in the wake of the brutal beating of Oleg Kashin, a reporter for Russian business daily Kommersant who had written widely, and not always favorably, about both pro- and anti-Kremlin youth movements.

More extraordinary were the actions of Natalia Vasiliyeva, a Moscow City Court Clerk, who recently chose to risk her job and future to come forward with the statement that the verdict in the most recent and very widely covered trial of former Yukos Oil head Mikhail Khodorkovsky had been mandated by some authority higher than the judge. Formerly the richest man in Russia, Mr. Khodorkovsky was first arrested in 2003 on charges of fraud; it is widely accepted that his arrest, trials and imprisonment were and continue to be politically motivated. Ms. Vasiliyeva's testimony only confirmed the suspicions that the rule of law in Russia is negligible.

As in the Middle East, social media have also played roles in helping Russians grapple with their country's internal decay. In 2009, Andrei Dymovsky, a police major from the southern port city of Novorossiysk, posted two widely-watched videos to YouTube in which he spoke to his despair at the necessity of taking bribes to survive, accused his superiors of ordering officers

to arrest innocent people, and appealed to Prime Minister Putin to reform the police service. He was predictably fired for his remarks, but his confessions prompted several other police officers around Russia to create similar videos detailing their grievances with the system. Moscow lawyer and 2010 Yale World Fellow Alexey Navalny uses his immensely popular blog to promote and publicize his courageous fight against corruption in Russia's state-owned corporations. He has, for instance, published a document detailing Russian oil company Transneft's embezzlement of $4 billion from the construction of a pipeline.

Given these developments, it would be reasonable to finger Russia as next to face the type of ferocious popular protests that have gripped the Arab world. There are certainly superficial similarities between Russia and the Arab world, but the carefully constructed regime of Putin and Medvedev is in no danger of falling so suddenly. Significantly, the reality of Russian life is far more positive than that endured by the Arab masses. Economically depressed as Russia's myriad of old, Soviet-built, one-industry cities may be, the twenty years since the fall of the Soviet Union have brought Russia to new heights of prosperity. In contrast, Hosni Mubarak's thirty years of rule brought only a tantalizing taste of promised economic improvements to the Egyptian people. Despite Western investment and oil riches, the Arab nations find themselves unable to provide jobs or the promise of a brighter future to their youthful and rapidly growing populations. The aging Russian nation is largely content with the improvements they have seen during their lives; vocal though the above opposition movements may be, they attract comparatively little popular support.

Unlike most Middle Eastern nations, Russia is a thoroughly tech-savvy country. The mastery of social media is not solely the purview of democracy and opposition activists—online announcements of corruption or exposés on the murders of journalists are quickly refuted by pro-regime online activists, whether sanctioned or not. Popular pro-Kremlin figures and organizations like the nationalist youth organization Nashi ("Ours") are active online and President Medvedev, who can boast of over 220,000 followers on Twitter, is famously committed to introducing the use of technology in government. He has pushed regional governors to publish blogs and use Twitter or popular social networking sites like VKontakte.ru to connect with local residents and to respond to their complaints. The sclerotic regimes that controlled the revolutionary Middle East countries have spearheaded no such initiatives, nor could their aging dictators boast of the same popular following as the young, dynamic duo of Putin and Medvedev. A recent poll done by the independent Levada Center puts Putin's popularity rating at 69 percent, while Medvedev's is at 66 percent.

Some of the difference in these dynamics can be attributed to the ruling regimes themselves. The fall of the Soviet Union crushed the pride that many Russians held in their history, power and country. But the thirteen years of Vladimir Putin's presidency and subsequent premiership have seen a resurgence of Russian pride and perceived power. He has taken pains to revive the pride Russia felt it had lost after the fall of the USSR, even finding it useful to place himself in visual contrast with the bumbling Russian President Boris Yeltsin of the 1990s. Where Yeltsin made international news for falling off of stages, Putin is visible riding motorcycles and ordering operations against Islamic terrorists. Russia has twice used its energy might to demonstrate it remains influential in Europe and flexed its still-formidable military muscle during the August 2008 conflict with Georgia. The revolting Middle Eastern peoples did not have these scraps of glory to grab onto.

But Russian leaders and oligarchs cannot expect their countrymen will stay sated forever. They have accepted the corruption and lawlessness that abounds in their country as necessities of the transition from a communist past to a capitalist future. As the size of their pocketbooks has increased, they have chosen to turn a blind eye to the problems endemic to their system. Yet, the heady promise of the post-Soviet days has begun to fade as Russian citizens are beginning to demand more of their government. It is now increasingly easy to envision the emergence of a popular protest movement propelled by citizen disgust with the ever-so-slow erosion of Russian rule of law, the growth of corruption and the rise of divestment.

If their complaints are not answered in the immediate future, the cracks that have begun to appear in the famously complacent Russian façade seem likely to give way to rifts that will, for better or worse, upend the Russian system. Putin and Medvedev's record on addressing issues of corruption make it doubtful that they are serious about fulfilling their promises to clean up graft, or even that they're capable of curing the problems that so desperately need their attention. There will be no revolt tomorrow; the Russian government does not need to fear the immediate fate of their Arab counterparts. But the discontent that has sprouted among ordinary citizens is indicative of the problems that they may soon have no choice but to face.

WIKILEAKS & THE MEDIA: MULTIPLE TAKES ON JULIAN ASSANGE

Jacob Anbinder

Whoever wrote that truth is stranger than fiction must have been an editor at *The Guardian*. In mid-2010, the staff of the London-based newspaper spent months haggling with a neurotic, silver-haired Australian vagabond named Julian Assange. His organization, WikiLeaks, had a stated mission to improve transparency among corporations and governments, yet took its own privacy extremely seriously. Assange claimed to possess some 200,000 secret diplomatic cables, given to him by a source he would not disclose but was widely suspected to be a U.S. army intelligence officer now being held in a military prison at Quantico, Va. Assange was shifty, distrustful of the 'mainstream media,' and prone to anger.

But, as *Guardian* correspondents ascertained, he was most definitely telling the truth about the cables. A deal was struck between the motley crew of WikiLeaks and five of the world's most reputable newspapers, and on November 28TH they began to publish reports on the documents' content. The findings were nothing if not sensational. Saudi Arabia begged the United States to contain Iran! Vladimir Putin's government is endemically corrupt! Muammar Qaddafi has a voluptuous Ukrainian nurse! Combined with the 470,000 military reports on the Iraq and Afghanistan Wars also released by WikiLeaks that year, it was by far the largest divulgence of classified government information in American history. Best of all, the entire story seemed plucked straight from a John le Carré novel.

Yet four months after 'Cablegate', governments, the media and the American public have yet to agree on the core issues posed by the so-called 'WikiLeaks era.' Is WikiLeaks a news organization, or a group of hackers with an agenda? Is the information the cables revealed groundbreaking, or does it merely confirm what we already knew about our foreign policy? That news coverage of Assange, who is awaiting extradition to Sweden on sexual assault charges, seemed to overshadow the cables themselves only complicates the matter. Now, however, WikiLeaks: Inside Julian Assange's War on Secrecy and Open Secrets: WikiLeaks, War and American Diplomacy, written by staff at *The Guardian* and *The New York Times* respectively, aim to chronicle the events leading up to the cables' release and provide context for their influence on the world of global diplomacy.

In WikiLeaks, *The Guardian*'s David Leigh and Luke Harding harness the cloak-and-dagger nature of the entire WikiLeaks affair to great effect. The result is a book that is both well-researched and well-written, though it unabashedly reads like a spy thriller. "As they proceeded up the M11 motorway the occupants peered back," they write, describing Assange's escape from London once the leak was made public. "There was no obvious sign of pursuit. Nonetheless, they periodically pulled off the road into a lay-by and waited—lights killed—in the gloom."

Meanwhile, Assange is in the backseat, dressed as a woman to avoid recognition. Cue the Hans Zimmer soundtrack, please.

Leigh and Harding's writing is quite appropriate because, as readers quickly learn, Assange saw himself and his organization as the targets of world governments even before most people had ever heard of him. "Assange was, at the best of times, difficult to contact, switching mobile phones, email addresses, and encrypted chat rooms as often as he changed his location," recalls *Guardian* editor Alan Rusbridger. Indeed, Leigh and Harding are at their best when providing such insights, however small, into Assange's publicly shady persona. In one chapter, the reader is transported back to Assange's childhood growing up on an abandoned pineapple farm on languid Magnetic Island, off the coast of northeastern Australia. "Its small population," write Leigh and Harding, "included hippies who slept on beaches and in rock caves." To them, the manner in which WikiLeaks operates today is inextricably linked with Assange's upbringing. Take the mistrust of authority that such a childhood engenders, combine it with the love of computer programming and knack for hacking Assange develops in grade school, and WikiLeaks seems the natural result.

But the overall portrait Leigh and Harding paint of Assange, with whom they and other *Guardian* staff spent months negotiating their cable-sharing agreement, is far from reverential. The two spend some twenty pages reconstructing the incidents that led to sexual assault charges against Assange. The chapter is painful to read, not only because it is twice as long as it needs to be, but also because the authors do not hesitate to inject their own speculation into their reportage. "Assange did often seem to have a restlessly predatory attitude towards women," they recall, blaming his upbringing in Australia ('the land of coarse jokes') for his behavior. A far more relevant and revelatory passage focuses on Assange's initial insistence that no names be redacted from the leaked documents. "Well, they're informants," a correspondent recalls him saying. "So, if they get killed, they've got it coming to them. They deserve it."

Whereas these pre-publication dealings with Assange are the highlight of WikiLeaks, the *Times*' account focuses on the information provided by the cables themselves. Open Secrets is largely comprised of articles published in the *Times* during its coverage of the documents' release, and thus lacks the cohesive message of *The Guardian*'s account. But for readers who did not follow the *Times*' reporting when it was first published, it offers a veritable encyclopedia of the cables, complete with an appendix featuring the full text of the documents that were published in the *Times*. Those who did read the *Times* last November will find little new, though there are original bits of analysis sprinkled throughout the compendium. If there is one theme of Open Secrets, it is how much more radical Assange is perceived by the *Times* and the American public than he is by the rest of the world. "Mr. Assange says he is a journalist, but he is not," writes Andrew Exum, a fellow at the Center for a New American Security, in one of the many columns, editorials, and op-eds that are included. "He is an activist, and to what end is not clear." Bill Keller, the *Times*' executive editor, seems to agree. "I do not regard Julian Assange as a partner, and I would hesitate to describe what WikiLeaks does as journalism," he writes in the introduction to the compendium. Contrast this statement with *The Guardian*'s Rusbridger, who condemns American reporters for their " reluctance to admit that Assange [is] a journalist." Indeed, a current of skepticism towards Americans runs throughout Leigh and Harding's book; they scoff at Senator Joseph Lieberman's call for the *Times* to be investigated for publishing the documents, and chide Keller for asking advice from the State Department's regarding which names to redact.

But regardless of how Americans and Britons are reacting now to Cablegate and Assange, the world's perception of both will ultimately depend on the long-term value of the information WikiLeaks made public. Both Open Secrets and WikiLeaks argue strongly that Cablegate will prove to be a monumental event in the history of investigative journalism—according to the *Times*, they are nothing less than "a secret chronicle of the United States' relations with the world in an age of war and terrorism." But neither book denies that the cables largely affirm what our government has already told us about its foreign policy. In Keller's words, they simply provide "texture, nuance and drama." The debate rests, in part, on how valuable such an affirmation can be. As many commentators have already noted, the cables likely played some role in provoking the ongoing turmoil in the Arab world. After all, it was a cable released by WikiLeaks that first confirmed Tunisian President Zine Ben Ali's "conspicuous displays of wealth," one of the key impetuses behind the protests in that country that sparked the regional movement. Still, at this early stage in the "WikiLeaks era," much remains in the dark. Julian Assange must be pleased.

NEGATIVE HISTORY

An Interview with Sze Tsung Leong

Harrison Monsky

When we think about where politics, history and photography might meet, countless iconic images come to mind. Chances are that most of those images—whether of a President's son saluting his father's coffin or of soldiers raising an American flag at Iwo Jima—recall people swept up in an event, a moment in history documented in light and chemicals.

Sze Tsung Leong takes photographs you might also call 'historical,' but not by attempting to capture people or events so much as historical change in itself. Trained as an architect at Berkeley and Harvard, Sze Tsung is most widely known for his 2004 series of photographs, History Images. While the series garnered more critical attention than political analysis, its wall-sized photographs of changing Chinese cityscapes offer a unique commentary on historical shifts in Chinese society. Many of the pieces dwell on contrasts: gleaming steel skyscrapers of the 2000s next to communist block apartments of the 1960s alongside Qing dynasty neighborhoods. The old neighborhoods are about to be bulldozed, already a heap of rubble, and sometimes entirely absent. There are no people in sight, just rubble, steel and concrete. An industrial coldness mars what appears in total as an epic building and demolition project that promises to leave no square foot untouched. Whereas his photographs take a grand scale and make bold impressions, Sze Tsung is soft-spoken and pensive, easily camouflaged among the gallery-going creatures of Chelsea in neutral grays and blacks. While his name links him to an ancestral Chinese heritage, he is a child more of globalization than of modern China; born to a Malaysian mother and a Chinese father, he grew up in Mexico, London and California. He approaches China as at once a relative outsider and a distant relative.

In one sense, the photographs visually document the staggeringly swift and large-scale modernization that we now commonly associate with contemporary China. But they also make a pointed interpretation of that modernization as a wholesale destruction of the past that is far from unprecedented. For Sze Tsung, this physical destruction, long envisioned by Beijing authorities and enabled by recent economic growth, is not unique, even if tragic. It has precedents in China's dynastic history and in Haussmann's replanning of Paris in the mid-19TH century. Unlike in London, many of Paris's medieval winding streets were demolished to make way for its famous boulevards under Napoleon and his urban planner Haussmann. In his own writing, Sze Tsung has likened the underlying visions of Napoleon's plan—modernization, military control and central authority—to those driving China's urban project.

The Politic recently met up with the artist in New York at the opening of his new series, Global Cities, at the Yossi Milo Gallery to talk photography and politics.

HM
Why photograph cities?

And why not include people?

STL
I was interested in photographing cities because they are the result of so many different forces. They are the result of political planning, ideological directives, economic objectives, social patterns—all of these things manifest in the built environments that surround us. These forces leave their mark on cities, which become living historical documents to read and interpret.

It's often assumed that to have people present in photographs, you need to photograph a person. But cities are the way they are because we live there. People are absolutely present in my photographs, because we leave our mark on the places we live. The configurations of streets and buildings, the proportions of windows and floors, the graffitied political slogans, the washing we hang from windows—these are examples of how our social patterns and the way we relate to history are inscribed in our built environments. And in many of my pictures there are many people physically present, only they appear very small because they are shown within the very large scale of the city.

HM
Is it fair to interpret your work as political protest?

STL
I don't think the function of art is as much to get a specific message across, as it is to encourage people to think and to question, and this is what I hope is

the effect of my work. My most political work is probably *History Images*, because I was working in an environment so saturated and determined by politics, and the series is an exploration of how the built environment—and history itself—can be manipulated through a political and ideological agenda. We are, unfortunately, all too familiar with the Chinese government's tactic of making what it does not approve of disappear through censorship, jailings, detentions, armed suppressions. I wanted to explore how this attitude also extends to the scale of the city and of history, where whole neighborhoods and districts, and all of the lives and histories they represent, can be erased and replaced when they no longer fit within the prevailing ideology.

Jiangbeizheng Jie I, Jiangbeicheng, Jiangbei District, Chongqing, 2003. From the series History Images. Chromogenic Color Print.

HM
What was the reaction to your work in China?

STL
The reaction was mainly one of understanding and sympathy for what I was doing. There was the general sense of the irreparable loss to Chinese heritage that happened with the destruction of these environments. But sometimes I would encounter people, often young people, who saw no problem with the destruction of the older neighborhoods, describing them as 'dilapidated' and 'dangerous', which is the same vocabulary the government was using to describe historic districts. Most of the older and more educated people, who had a longer view of history, saw the destruction as undermining the larger cultural context.

HM
Can history and development coexist?

STL
Yes, I think that modernization can coexist with the preservation of history. I grew up in Mexico City, where you strongly feel the presence of the city's many histories, from its Mexica foundations as Tenochtitlán, to its Spanish colonial architecture, to its present identity as a modern metropolis. I also lived in London, where the juxtaposition of its many histories has given the city a vibrant richness and complexity. China's attitude towards its urban development has been aided by a very blunt economic fact that it is much easier and cheaper to destroy wholesale than to integrate and conserve. In the future, there might be a deep and increasing regret in China at its history of erasing its history.

HM
Who has influenced your work?

STL
The encompassing depiction of landscape, from the early Northern European painters such as Patinir and Bruegel, to the seventeenth century Dutch landscape painters, to the mid-nineteenth century photographers, has been very influential. The photographer Felice Beato's work, particularly his images of war in Crimea and China in the mid-nineteeth century, had a strong effect on me. They are images of how warfare leaves its mark on the environment. Then, the warfare was between nations. Now, the conflict is internal—between a nation's present and its past histories, and between a ruling ideology and the elements that do not fit within its picture.

1.

1.
New Fengdu, Chongqing Municipality, 2003.
From the series History Images.
Chromogenic Color Print.

2.
Zhongyuan Liangwan Cheng II,
Putuo District, Shanghai, 2005.
From the series History Images.
Chromogenic Color Print.

3.
Suzhou Jie, Daoxiang Yuan,
Haidian District, Beijing, 2004.
From the series History Images.
Chromogenic Color Print.

4.
Chunshu, Xuanwu District, Beijing, 2004.
From the series History Images.
Chromogenic Color Print.

2.

3.

4.

Beizhuanzi II, Siming District, Xiamen, 2004. From the series History Images. Chromogenic Color Print.

HM
Where do you see China moving in the future?

STL
The large-scale destruction and reshaping of China's environments has been possible because of its high concentration of power. What happens over the next fifty years will depend on whether China chooses to hold on to its insular authoritarianism or if it chooses to allow a more open and varied society to emerge. There's the optimistic view that China will have a more integrated relationship to the rest of the world and that seeing its role in an international context will end its inflexible justifications of authoritarian and fearful behavior. That's at least my hope. But from the way the government has been conducting itself recently towards its citizens, it's unfortunately a dim hope.

HM
What's the difference between the work you do and that of a photojournalist?

STL
Photojournalism is usually an immediate visual representation of events as they are happening, and intended primarily for the specific contexts of media reportage: newspapers, magazines, television. My work is intended to be seen primarily within the contexts of museums, galleries, and books. My attempt is not to document specific stories or events, but to portray larger phenomena, such as the destruction of history in *History Images*, our perception of the foreign and familiar in *Horizons*, or forming a picture of the world in *Cities*.

HM
How does your work relate to Globalization, especially your new series that documents cities in different parts of the world?

STL
My work is about a relationship to the world. Perhaps it is related to my own experience in the world—my paternal grandparents and maternal great-grandparents were, respectively, Cantonese and Hokkien. Around the time of the First World War, they left for England and Malaysia, where my parents were born. I am Mexican-born, grew up in Mexico, the UK, and the US, and have British and now American passports. In my work hopefully it is apparent that 'Globalization'—whatever that means—is not at all new. In my series *Horizons* and *Cities*, there are many traces of how different parts of the world relate to other parts of the world. You see a Roman amphitheatre in Amman, Spanish colonial architecture in Quito, a Portugese church in Macau, Greek revival architecture in London, or reflective-glass high-rises everywhere.

All images © Sze Tsung Leong, Courtesy Yossi Milo Gallery, New York.

REDEFINING ARAB MODERATION

INTERVIEW WITH MARWAN MUASHER

Conducted by
Nick Rugoff & Jaclyn Delligatti

Marwan Muasher is a prominent Jordanian diplomat and politician who has been involved in Middle East peace efforts for the past 20 years. He served in a variety of posts in the Jordanian government including Minister of Foreign Affairs and Deputy Prime Minister, where he was in charge of reform and government performance. He was the first Jordanian Ambassador to Israel and also served as Ambassador to the United States, during which time he negotiated the first free trade agreement between the US and an Arab nation. Mr. Muasher was also the Senior Vice President of External Affairs at the World Bank from 2007–2010, and he is currently the Vice President for Studies of the Middle East Program at the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace. His recent memoir *The Arab Center: The Promise of Moderation* traces the negotiations among Israel, the Palestinians, the Arab states and the outside world from 1991 to 2004.

NR
You recently spoke at Yale about 'Redefining Arab Moderation.' What were the core ideas of your talk?

MM
Moderation is a western construct that when used in describing the Arab world, focuses on a single issue—the Arab-Israeli peace conflict. In that sense, some Arab countries—like Egypt, Jordan, and Saudi Arabia—are defined as moderate. When it comes to other issues of concern to Arab citizens, like good governance, recent events have shown that you cannot call these countries moderate. I am proposing a new definition for Arab moderation that cuts across all issues of concern to Arab citizens and includes aspects like reform in addition to peace, rather than focusing on only one issue.

JD
What do the ongoing protests say about the way the Arab world views its future and its governments?

MM
It's clear to me that while the protests may have been triggered by difficult economic conditions, they are not just about the economy. Demand for better government is the underlying theme across all countries. If we look at the slogans protestors are putting forward, very few of them have to do with the economy.

JD
You were the first diplomat to open a Jordanian embassy in Israel, and Jordan has been instrumental in attempts to secure peace between Israel and the region. What effect will the loss of a pro-Israel Egyptian leader have on stability in the region?

MM
I don't think it will change the existing peace treaties, but I think it will make Israel revisit its position after the events of the past few weeks. Israel's longstanding claim that it is the only democracy in the Arab world cannot be reconciled with Israel's prodding of the Obama administration to support Mubarak. The cheers across the international community for Arabs yearning for freedom cannot exclude cheers for Palestinians yearning for freedom from the Israeli occupation. My hope is that this will accelerate a push for a solution to the Arab-Israeli conflict.

NR
What do you foresee happening in Jordan?

MM
Jordan is similar to other Arab countries in yearning for better government, but it's not similar to Egypt as there are no demands for the King to step down since he is still a unifying figure. Many Jordanians are calling for serious reform to the system. I firmly believe we are entering a new era where business as usual cannot be sustained in any Arab country. Governments will have to either lead a reform process from above, or watch things collapse from below.

JD
What role, if any, should the United States play in future Middle Eastern uprisings? How do they balance ensuring security in the Middle East without appearing paternalistic?

MM
These uprisings are domestic issues and it is up to the countries themselves to decide how they want to govern themselves. At the same time, I think the United States can support efforts to democratize without imposing democracy from the outside. For a long time, the United States maintained a policy that prioritized stability over democracy. This was largely because of both its ties to Israel as well as demand for the region's oil. The United States now needs to support both stability and democracy.

NR
What should the United States do to win the hearts and minds of Muslims across the Middle East?

MM
President Obama started on the right track two years ago with his speech in Cairo. He basically told the Muslim and Arab worlds that the United States would collaborate with them as partners rather than imposers of reform. This needs to be translated into action, and not by imposing reform, but by making clear the United States' position that it will prioritize issues in the region besides the Arab-Israeli conflict.

NR
How can Middle Eastern countries deal with demographic problems caused by enormous youth populations facing pervasive unemployment?

MM
This is a real challenge in the Arab world. There is a huge youth bulge where 70% of the population is under 30. Most of the protestors have been frustrated young people. There needs to be an increase in productivity so that the market can absorb all of these people. We also need better foreign investment, but these things cannot come about without proper reform. We need to create the proper environments, including legal systems, that are conducive to growth, reduce corruption and provide better checks and balances so that no branch of government dominates others. All of these are crucial to economic reform. The Arab world has adopted a policy of economic reform before freedom—essentially, bread before freedom—which did not work. It is clear that the region needs more economic reform, coupled with more freedom.

JD
In the past few weeks immigration from North African states to Europe has increased, particularly from Tunisia to Italy, as young people hope to find work. What will the political ramifications of this increased immigration be?

MM
Europe has initiated a variety of partnerships like the Barcelona Process with the Arab world because Europeans are clearly concerned about these immigration issues. Arabs are also concerned because we would like to keep this talent in the Arab world. This is connected to the previous question, where by creating economic reform and better governments (which I hope receive better support from the European Union), Arabs can create jobs that keep these citizens at home.

NR
What types of reforms are needed in Arab education systems?

MM
The quality of education and curriculum in the Arab world needs to be reevaluated in a major way. The current system encourages submission and obedience, and subscribes to truths that are absolute rather than relative. We need to move towards a system that encourages diversity, tolerance and critical thinking. These are not only important skills for the market place, but more importantly, crucial skills for making people better citizens.

FORGING A NEW FUTURE

INTERVIEW WITH KENNETH POLLACK

Conducted by
Donna Horning

Kenneth Pollack '88 is the Director of the Saban Center for Middle East Policy at the Brookings Institution. He has served as a CIA intelligence analyst on Iraqi and Iranian military issues and Director for Near East, South Asian, and Persian Gulf Affairs with the National Security Council. He has written many articles and books on international relations, most recently *A Path Out of the Desert: A Grand Strategy for America in the Middle East*. He received his BA from Yale and his PhD from MIT.

DH
How has the transition out of the intelligence community and into the Brookings Institute been for you?

KMP
When you leave government and move over to a think tank, at one level you lose the immediacy of being able to contribute to policy on a real-time basis, but what you gain is the freedom to think creatively and longer-term. There are still folks in government who are governed by the tyranny of the inbox, who always have to be worried about what they have to do immediately, and for them long-term thinking is typically "what am I going to be doing this afternoon?" Obviously their ability to think creatively is ultimately governed by what the policy of the administration is.

DH
How does one advocate these long-term policies to governments that are dictated by the tyranny of the inbox?

KMP
Well, it's hard, and I'm not certain I've succeeded yet. In 2002, I was arguing that we shouldn't invade Iraq until we've dealt with the peace process, until we've thought about how to build Iraq, but the Bush administration didn't pay any attention to that. In 2004, our Iraq strategy was failing, and we had to move to a true counterinsurgency strategy. They eventually did that, but it took them another 2–3 years. Starting in 2002, I was warning that the Middle East was in a pre-revolutionary state, and the US had to adopt a new policy, one of encouraging reform, to try to head off violent revolutions. In 2008, I was trying to make an argument that terrorism is not a problem in the Middle East; terrorism is a symptom. But in 2008 all the American political process wanted to do was get out of Iraq.

DH
What do you think of the decision to intervene in Libya and the methods that have been used so far by the armed forces?

KMP
I was in favor of the humanitarian intervention. I'm one of these liberal intervention guys. I was in the Clinton administration when we saw Srebrenica. I came away from that saying "we can't let there be another Srebrenica," we can't let there be another Rwanda. That said, I always recognized that intervention in Libya was going to be an incredibly difficult operation. That it was going to be open-ended potentially, that just intervening for the defensive purpose of saving the people of Libya was inherently problematic, because it was an operation that did not contain the elements of its own closure. You couldn't just go in, save the people of eastern Libya, and then walk away and leave Qaddafi in power.

DH
So how does one build a nation after a bloody civil war?

KMP
It's incredibly difficult stuff. What I will say first is we could have done Iraq and Afghanistan so much better than we did them. These kinds of exercises are always extraordinarily difficult, but we'd learned a lot by the end of the 1990s. By the end of the 1990s we had a book and a kit, and the problem was that the Bush administration came into office and started by throwing the book and the kit out the window. So point number one is that it doesn't have to be as bad as Iraq and Afghanistan. Point number two is that it's always the kind of thing that takes time, it certainly takes some money, though it doesn't have to be nearly as expensive as Iraq and Afghanistan. You basically start out by restoring the economy, creating basic services, and building a political system over time.

DH
Do you think it is imperative to get a UN resolution to execute this mission successfully, as Obama has? Do you think it's necessary for NATO to be involved?

KMP
I think the UN has a very big role to play. I think that especially once Qaddafi falls, it is going to be necessary to go back to the UN and get basically a UN mandate to provide all kinds of humanitarian development assistance for Libya, which they're going to need. The problem with NATO and the UN is that they have a very difficult time doing anything if the US isn't involved.

DH
How do you think these revolutions change the regional situation of Iran and Turkey?

KMP
I think that it potentially helps both of them, but in very different ways. Turkey is a Muslim country that has successfully made the transition to democracy, and as a result they have had a certain amount of economic success. I think there are a lot of things the Turks have to teach these different Arab states as they now begin this transition. There are a lot of reforms that are going to have to take place in the Arab world, and the Turks have gone through many of them already.

With Iran it's a lot more complicated, as is everything with Iran, because in the short term I think there's no question that the Iranians have been to a certain extent advantaged by what happened. The Iranians look around the region, they see America's greatest Arab ally and their worst foe, which is Mubarak, fallen from power, and chaos in Egypt. All of the Arab countries are now focused much more inwardly, and the United States is completely wrapped up with their internal problems, and there just isn't going to be the same degree of international pressure on Iran and international coordination against Iran. And oh by the way, the price of oil is still well up over $100 a barrel as a result of this unrest, which is also helpful to Iran.

I think the bigger problem for Iran is the long term one. If the Middle East does move in this direction, if you see greater democratization and economic reform and social reform, that is going to make the Iranians look really bad, because increasingly they will be seen as out of step with the region. They will go from being the champions of the anti-status quo movement, which made Iran and Iranian leaders very popular on the Arab street, to becoming a dinosaur.

DH
Do you think these revolutions will be successful and that unfortunate long-term scenario will play out for Iran?

KMP
My immediate answer is *insh' Allah*—the Arabic for 'If God Wills,' and to a certain extent 'I hope so.' It's very hard to say what the future of the Middle East is. The most positive thing out there is that the people of the Arab world desperately want this; this is the direction they want to go in. And so far, many of the revolutions and upheavals that we've seen in the region seem pretty good. The problem of course is that not every autocrat in the region is in fact ready to reform, or reform in a meaningful way, and some may just be trying to buy off their people. And beyond that, revolutions are inherently unpredictable, they often get hijacked, sometimes they just lead to chaos, and transitions to democracy are inherently fraught with problems. What do I see for the long term? My guess is that we'll probably get a combination, we'll get some states doing pretty well, some states doing less well but still heading in the right direction, and other states like Libya descending into civil war. We have to just hope and do our best to help the states that matter most in the region—Egypt and Saudi Arabia in particular—and make sure they do move in the right direction. Iraq is another extremely important country that's headed in the right direction, but that we are trying desperately to forget, which I think is a huge mistake.

DH
Do you believe that there will be a major reset in relations that most of the Arab countries have with Israel?

KMP
No one knows. Again, I'm hopeful that in the long-term progress toward democracy all across the Arab world will actually result in a much better relationship between Israelis and Arabs. Obviously we have a lot of empirical evidence that democracies don't fight democracies—democratic peace theory—and you can also imagine democratic Arab states that are much more focused on economic development would want a better relationship with Israel, which is obviously a very dynamic, very modern economy, and would have a lot to offer them.

I'm pessimistic about the prospects for peace in the near term. I think the Israeli public is just terrified of what's going on, and my experience with the Israeli government is that if their people are terrified they will not elect a leader that is willing to take risks for peace. I think the most interesting is the medium term, where you could see Arab democracies which act in many ways more hostile to Israel than the autocracies. Mubarak may not have liked Israel, but he understood that it was bad for him to pick fights with Israel. But democracies give vent to popular sentiment, and there's a lot of anti-Semitism and anti-Zionism among the Arab people.

DH
I'm wondering how you think differing local cultures will contribute to this process. What is Islam's capacity to make democratic reforms?

KP
I wrote my doctoral thesis on how Arab culture shapes Arab militaries and there is absolutely nothing about Islam that should make it problematic for democratization and development in the Arab states. The Islamic religion, like most great religions, is infinitely malleable. In every part of the world we've seen democracies flourish. What's important about that is that in every single one of these places, beforehand, you had lots of really smart people insisting that those countries could never be democratic because their cultures just weren't suited to it. But democracy is a set of principles that can be adapted to all kinds of different cultures.

The problem is the educational system. The Arab Human Development Report has done wonderful work in demonstrating this by talking about how Arab educational methods do not encourage creativity, do not encourage the creation of knowledge, do not encourage Arabs who can function in a modern 21ST century information economy. I don't think anything about Arab culture is problematic for democracy. I do see traditional methods of education as being problematic for economic reform.

DH
So does educational reform have to come from inside a country, or is there something that can be done internationally on a much larger scale?

KP
The truth is that these kinds of reforms always have to grow organically, they always have to come from inside the country, but that doesn't mean that there isn't a role for outside assistance, whether it comes from countries or NGOs or international organizations. It's a tricky balance, because we have to respect the fact that they need to take the lead because all of these reforms have to be comfortable to them. One of the biggest mistakes we've made in the past is to take this kind of cookie-cutter approach, where we go into all these different counties and just say, "do these five or ten things and you'll be fine." That never works. We've got to respect that they have to take the lead, they have to be the ones to do most of the work, but by the same token we shouldn't just assume that they will be able to do it all on their own without our assistance, and we can just walk away.

REVOLUTION AND UNCERTAINTY IN THE MIDDLE EAST

INTERVIEW WITH DANIEL KURTZER

Conducted by
Donna Horning

Professor Daniel Kurtzer of Princeton has served in the United States Foreign Service for 29 years, as both Ambassador to Egypt (1997–2001) during the Clinton administration and Ambassador to Israel (2001–2005) during the Bush administration. He played an integral role in crafting the 1988 Shultz Peace Initiative for the Middle East, as well as President Obama's Cairo speech in 2009. He has also served as an advisor for the Iraq Study Group, a board member at the American University in Cairo and the first Commissioner of the Israel Baseball League. He recently co-authored *Negotiating Arab-Israeli Peace: American Leadership in the Middle East*. He received his Ph.D. from Columbia.

DH
Do you have a theory to explain the 'domino effect' of revolutions spreading through the Middle East these last few months? How do you anticipate it might spread?

DK
I don't think anyone can adequately explain why the problems that have been well-known for many years have now erupted region-wide. There seems to be a growing lack of fear on the part of populations in authoritarian regimes—that appears to be one of the factors here. Each country demonstrates in a different way a willingness to stand up to autocratic regimes, and it seems to have an effect on their neighbors.

DH
When you were Ambassador to Egypt, did you have any particularly memorable interactions with Mubarak or with the Egyptian army? Was there any sense at all that he would the meet the political end that he has?

DK
On the second question, no. Nobody anticipated that his presidency would end this way. I talked to him all the time. He and I met on the average of once a month, either alone or with delegations. So I got to know him quite well. In that respect, I would not agree with those who demonize him. He clearly oversaw a regime that was authoritarian and autocratic, but this was not Saddam Hussein or Hafiz Al-Assad or Muammar Qaddafi. It was not the same kind of total disregard for people that you see in some other countries. That doesn't excuse the regime's abuses, but I think history will have to judge his presidency carefully.

DH
What do you see as the impact of this regional instability after five years, and then maybe further in the future, say 30 years?

DK
It's impossible to know, and I would discount anyone who makes those kinds of projections. First of all, we are in the first round of a fifteen round bout in each of these countries, and each of them is different. Egypt has started out on a constitutional political reform method, but as some recent articles have indicated, progress is scratchy and uneven. Egypt is the best case so far of change. At the other end of the spectrum, you have a Libya that has deteriorated into the worst kind of internal violence, in which both sides seem intent on fighting to the finish. So I don't think we can project even beyond a couple of weeks, let alone months or years about how this is going to emerge. The one thing I would say is that if the Egyptian transition can proceed relatively smoothly, it will set a benchmark for the rest of the region, and that will be a positive thing. But at the same time if the Egyptian transition does not proceed smoothly, I think the region is in for a long period of instability.

DH
If you were still Ambassador to Egypt how would you be advising President Obama at this time on his role in the upcoming elections, if you think he has a role to play at all?

DK
I think the role of the United States and any outside party right now is extremely limited. In Egypt, this is a nationalistic uprising. There were no foreign policy issues that seemed to motivate the opposition that grew over the past ten weeks. I think there would be great resentment on the part of that opposition to any country, including the United States, to come in and suggest how the transition should proceed. At the same time, I think the United States and others should be ready to respond to reasonable, legitimate Egyptian requests for assistance, particularly economic assistance, if it is focused on building jobs. One of the great problems I foresee is that the political transition may start to move much faster than the economic development that is required to provide the kind of jobs and economic success people are demanding, and there could be a dissonance between those factors.

DH
You played a major role in crafting the Shultz Peace Initiative in 1988. Do you anticipate the US enacting something else like that in the near future, or maybe some sort of economic development version of it? Do you have any idea what an ideal plan would look like?

DK
I did testify in Congress about a year ago, and suggested that it was time then for a more comprehensive US strategy that included the articulation of US views on final status issues, much more support for Palestinian state-building activities, interaction with the Arab heads of state at that time who had formulated the Arab Peace Initiative and continued focus on implementing the requirements of the roadmap with respect to settlements, violence, incitement and mobility. I think a comprehensive approach is what is needed now, not something piecemeal and certainly not simply demanding that negotiations restart. Without an agenda or terms of reference for those negotiations, they will start from a position in which progress is impossible. So yes, there are ideas out there. I hope the administration considers the idea of a comprehensive strategy, because even in the midst of this upheaval in the Arab world, the Palestine/Israel conflict has not gone away. There's never a good time to work on it, and the time now I think is important to exploit.

DH
Do you believe that it would be more or less impossible to make progress in the region without resolving the Israel/Palestine conflict first?

DK
No, I don't believe in those linkages that suggest either that you start with the Palestine/Israel conflict or that you start with Arab democratization. I think those are artificial linkagesl, and they often serve as excuses to not work on the second issue. I think we can walk and chew gum, as the expression goes, meaning that we can provide the kind of support that's necessary in places that are seeking democracy, and also provide the support and creative strategy ideas to move the peace process forward. It works in a kind of symbiotic way: one will help the other, but one does not take precedence over the other.

DH
At what point do you think the United States' belief in upholding democracy around the world hits the tipping point with international security, from the diplomatic point of view? Do you have a sense of a clear cut-off point in which the United States must defend their interests abroad, even with respect to non-democratic regimes?

DK
No, I think it's a case-by-case determination, and the Middle East has been the poster child for this kind of analysis. We spent a long time advocating democracy but also working very closely with authoritarian regimes in the interest both of stability and the pursuit of very concrete American interests. There's no general rule here. International relations theory may suggest some ideas, but when you sit behind a desk in the Oval Office the theory usually flies out the window in the face of concrete realities. To give you one example, even during the Egyptian uprising the United States had to weigh the very specific interests that we have in Egypt. Everything we move militarily into the area east of Egypt goes through or over Egypt, and therefore even though we clearly have an interest in democracy, we also have an interest to maintain the relationship with a country which is as strategically located as Egypt. So it's a case-by-case, very hard-headed analysis that gets tougher the closer you get to the Oval Office.

DON'T BLAME THE SPIES

INTERVIEW WITH PAUL PILLAR

Conducted by
Nick Rugoff & Christopher Howell

Paul Pillar is a 28-year veteran of the Central Intelligence Agency, and currently a visiting professor at Georgetown. At the CIA, he most recently served as National Intelligence Officer for the Near East and South Asia. He has also held a variety of analytical and managerial positions, including Chief of Analytic Units, where he covered portions of the Near East, the Persian Gulf and South Asia. Mr. Pillar also served in the National Intelligence Council as one of the original members of its Analytic Group. He has also headed the Assessments and Information Group of the DCI Counterterrorist Center, and from 1997 to 1999 was Deputy Chief of the Center. Mr. Pillar is a retired officer in the U.S. Army Reserve and served on active duty from 1971–1973, including a tour of duty in Vietnam. He graduated summa cum laude from Dartmouth, received a B.Phil from Oxford, and an M.A. and Ph.D. from Princeton.

NR
What do the recent uprisings across the Middle East mean for al-Qaeda?

PP
So far, the uprisings are bad news for al-Qaeda for two basic reasons. First, there has been substantial political change in Tunisia and Egypt that has occurred for reasons that have nothing to do with the extremists; al-Qaeda was totally sidelined. Additionally, as more democracy emerges in the Middle East and creates more peaceful channels for people to pursue their political objectives and voice their grievances, the violent channels advocated by extremists like al-Qaeda will become much less attractive and relevant. That is the case so far, but much can still happen that would provide opportunities for groups like al-Qaeda to make inroads. This is especially true in places where there are power vacuums or overall chaos—Libya is a good example. Moreover, if hopes for greater political change in places like Egypt are disappointed, al-Qaeda's message may again sound credible.

NR
What do they mean for Israel?

PP
The Israelis are deeply worried about these events for several reasons. The primary concern is not that we're going to have a new Egyptian-Israeli War or anything like that, because everyone understands that Israel retains military superiority over any one, or any combination, of its neighbors. The worries concern the push for greater popular sovereignty in Arab countries, which highlights the lack of popular sovereignty among the Palestinians in the occupied territories. This also undercuts part of the narrative that Israeli spokesmen have repeatedly invoked—the idea that authoritarian regimes in the Arab world are largely to blame for continuing to stoke the conflict with Israel in order to distract their own people and justify their own oppression. If those authoritarian regimes are replaced with democracies, this narrative wears thin. Finally, there has to be worry about the damage done to another major narrative used in the United States, which is that we have an extraordinary relationship with Israel because it is the only democracy in the Middle East. If political changes in Arab countries lead to Israel no longer being the only democracy in the Middle East, this would undermine the most important basis for this ongoing relationship.

NR
What are the implications of the Libyan intervention for other 'rogue states' like Iran and North Korea?

PP
I worry that an unfortunate message has been already sent, given what we've done by using force to support an ouster of Qaddafi. Qaddafi took a very important step in reaching an understanding and formal agreement with the United States and Britain eight years ago. He agreed to get out of the terrorism business, cooperate on terrorism issues and give up his programs to develop unconventional weapons. The unfortunate message now is that the West is not to be trusted. Qaddafi is a ruler who

took significant steps to reverse many of his earlier policies, and still winds up being the target of regime change. Therefore, people such as the rulers in Tehran will reach the conclusion that they would be suckers to get drawn into an agreement with the West about something like giving up a nuclear weapons program. I believe what has happened in Libya has potentially killed any type of nuclear agreement with Iran, at least for now.

NR
What is the role of the United States in the 'new' Middle East?

PP
I think President Obama set the correct tone in his 2009 speech in Cairo. Although I disagree with the direction we've taken in using military force in Libya, in many ways the tone that President Obama has tried to set in the Libya crisis is still consistent with his message in Cairo. Overall, we are headed in the right direction as the United States is giving up the hope and pretense of controlling events in the region, and of being the dominant force in the region, particularly by exercising its military power. Instead, we are seeking ways to have a better, more stable and more peaceful relationship with a variety of peoples and regimes in the Middle East, to the benefit of everyone involved.

NR
What are the United States' obligations to the people of Libya?

PP
I believe that Colin Powell's Pottery Barn rule—'you break it, you buy it'—comes into play. This is a major unanswered question that we are still left with in the wake of President Obama's recent address to the nation. If Qaddafi does fall, where does the responsibility lie for the immense and very messy task of constructing a new political and economic order in Libya? We're talking about a country that was under this weird regime for four decades where Qaddafi endeavored to destroy or break down anything that resembled civil society or an alternative power structure. When trying to build a new order, there will be very little to work with. My own view is that to the extent that we do get involved, as we already have, in exercising military power to hasten the demise of the current regime, then we do have a major share of the responsibility for taking care of what is left.

NR
Given your experience in the CIA, what are the biggest or most common mistakes an analyst makes and how can he or she avoid them?

PP
A slightly facetious answer is that if one were to identify any one or small number of mistakes, then one has already made a mistake by spending too much time on particular types of errors to the exclusion of others. This sort of thing comes up often whenever there are the recriminations after a failure or perceived failure, and we have an investigation. We hear a lot about reforming and fixing, but it's always about the perceived mistake from the most recent crisis or flap. This is an example of preparing to fight the last war. There are many different ways in which errors are made every week, though the great majority of them never become public, and to focus on any particular one would be a mistake.

NR
Has the role of the CIA changed since under the Obama administration?

PP
Not in any significant way. From what I can see from the outside, the very bad relationship between the intelligence community and the Bush administration has cycled back to something a little closer to the norm. In terms of the basic functions performed in support of the formulation and execution of policy, I don't see any fundamental change.

NR
What does the criticism following Director of National Intelligence James R. Clapper Jr.'s recent remarks say about the relationship between the intelligence community and political issues?

PP
It shows that the intelligence community will always be in a no-win situation in certain respects. Director Clapper was criticized for making a public comment about Qaddafi's staying power. If he had not made that comment and if the United States, after getting more deeply involved at higher cost in Libya, found that Qaddafi was especially difficult to dislodge, Director Clapper and the intelligence community would be criticized for not saying enough. These sorts of no-win situations are day-to-day dilemmas that the intelligence community faces and they're never going away. Jim Clapper is only the most recent intelligence chief to get in the line of fire in this respect.

CH
Has the technological revolution caused an overreliance on Signals Intelligence to the detriment of our human intelligence capabilities?

PP
That's an old story as it relates to signals intelligence and other technical intelligence; it's been around for decades. There's no one method of collection that's better than any other or one that's inferior to another. Proper intelligence collection makes use of all the available disciplines, so I don't think there's a particular problem here.

CH
What are the biggest misconceptions Americans have about the intelligence community?

PP
The single biggest misconception is that if it's properly constituted and properly run, it can find out just about anything about just about any subject in the world. People seem to believe that if we run things right, our policymakers won't be faced with a large amount of uncertainty. That is a misconception because there will always be a great amount of uncertainty, no matter how well our bureaucracy collects and analyzes intelligence.

Another major misconception is that intelligence drives or guides policy. That is the way it is supposed to work in the textbooks, but if you look historically at the major foreign policy decisions—big departures like going to war or major redirections of policy like those of Ronald Reagan—these are almost never determined or even guided in any significant way by conclusions from the intelligence community. They are the product of other influences and forces, including the policymaker's own interpretations of how the world works.

TURKEY AND THE WORLD

INTERVIEW WITH VEYSEL AYHAN

Conducted by
Sabire Ipek Demir

Dr. Veysel Ayhan is a Professor of International Relations at Abant Izzet Baysal University (Turkey), and the Gulf of Basra Advisor at ORSAM (Center for Middle Eastern Strategic Studies). Educated at Uludag University (BA 1998, MA 2002, PhD 2005), he currently teaches courses on nationalism and minorities in the Middle East, global and regional energy policies and social opposition movements in the Middle East. He has published three books on the Middle East: *Saddam Hussein: While The History Re-Written* (with Ferhat Pirincci), *Way to the Empire: Middle East and Oil* and *Lebanon: War, Peace, Resistance and Relations with Turkey*.

Note: This interview was originally conducted in Turkish and has been translated by the author.

SID
What is Turkey's strategic importance in its region?

VA
From geographical, cultural and historical aspects, Turkey reflects Europe on the one hand, and the Middle East, Caucasus and Central Asia on the other hand. Turkey's political culture is both influenced by the Istanbul-based Byzantine political structure, and the Damascus and Baghdad-based Umayyad and Abbasid political structures. Historically, many different religions and sects have lived together in Anatolia. From an economic perspective, Turkey's strategic location stands out as a safe route for the flow of energy between East and the West.

One other unique quality of Turkey is that despite having a large Muslim population, it has never been colonized by a Western country. Thus, the fundamental principle of Turkish foreign policy has always been preserving its equal status in its relations with the West. Therefore, countries such as France or the US often have problems in their relations with Turkey.

SID
What is your opinion of the view that Europe is 'losing' Turkey as the nation turns towards Middle Eastern allies, especially after its ongoing frustration in dealing with the European Union?

VA
This view originates from the ignorance of the changes in international relations and Turkish foreign policy in the last 30 years. If we make a historical analysis, we see that Turkey has been an important actor in the region for centuries. However, the Middle East has gone under the military, political and cultural hegemony of the great powers after 1918. Iran, Iraq, Jordan, Palestine and the Gulf countries were under the political and military dominance of Britain. In other words, Britain was the power that controlled the Iraqi side of the Turkish-Iraqi border. Besides, France emerged as a military and political power in the Middle East and established military control over Syria and Lebanon and ruled those countries until the end of the Second World War. It is not realistic to ask why there were no relations between Turkey and Syria at that era. Within the same period, the Soviet Union emerged as a great power, and conquered the whole of the Caucasus and Central Asia. Therefore, there was only Britain, France and the Soviet Union for Turkey to establish relations with and until the end of the Second World War, Turkey dealt with those states.

During the Cold War period, Turkey struggled with security concerns arising from the USSR threat. Moreover, the rivalry between the US and the USSR in the Middle East, Arab-Israeli wars, and the Iran-Iraq wars created instability in the region. Turkey didn't have another option beyond turning to Europe.

However, with the end of the Cold War, Turkey started building its relationships with Caucasia and Central Asian countries. The Baku-Tbilisi-Ceyhan oil pipeline project and cooperation with Russia on many issues, including natural gas flow, gained priority. While the conflict in the former Yugoslavia urged Turkey to play an active role in the Balkans, the 2003 Iraq War and the political and military failures of the US prepared the ground for Turkey to focus on the Middle East more intensively. Turkey now forms high-level cooperation with all countries in the region, including the GCC [Gulf Cooperation Council] countries. In the meantime, Turkey is still determined to pursue EU membership, and is an important member of NATO.

The supporters of this view just don't see that the political, military and economic impact of the West on the Middle East has weakened in the recent years. It's completely normal for Turkey and its neighbors in the region to enhance their relations.

SID
Turkey used to be Israel's closest ally in the region and a moderator between Israel and the Arab world. What are your comments on the Mavi Marmara Flotilla incident and Turkey's stance towards Israel?

VA
Although Turkey has developed strong relations with Israel since 1948, she never gave up supporting the fundamental rights of the Palestinian population, and the formation of an independent Palestine with 1967 borders. However, Israel began taking increasingly radical actions since 2000, launching a war on Lebanon as well as attacking the Gaza Strip, which obligated Turkey to reconsider her relations with Israel. Israel's hostile actions impeded Turkey's efforts to act as a mediator of the situation. As a country aiming at stability and increased cooperation in the region, Turkey couldn't continue her close relations with a pro-war Israeli administration. Furthermore, Turkey realized that the current Israeli administration would never support the formation of an independent Palestine. Supporting the violent policies of the Israeli right wing would have diminished the reputation and credibility of Turkey in the Middle East.

SID
Do you believe that stability can be reached in the region in the short run?

VA
Since the demands for political change has its roots in the problems of the inner structures of these countries, I wouldn't expect the process to be completed in a short period. Remember that Arab nationalism, which started with Colonel Nasser in 1952, caused instability in numerous countries' political structures until the 1970s. Hence, I think the current civil movements will remain effective in the international arena, especially in the Middle East and North Africa, for a long time.

SID
So, do you see the structural transformations in the Middle East and Northern Africa as the beginning of a long-lasting chaos?

VA
The current transformations in the region do not foreshadow stability in the short run. All the countries of the region will be more or less affected by the change. I pay close attention to the process in Egypt, because I anticipate that demands for reform will be stronger in the region after the process plays out in Egypt. Nonetheless, the change movements will be much more painful in countries where political structures rely on a specific social group. For example, the Najd region in Saudi Arabia, Jordanian Arab tribes in Jordan and Sunni Arabs in Bahrain are the preservers of the regime. The groups that appear to be the preservers of the regime may use violence to try to suppress the demands for reform. Therefore I believe the region is drifting into a state of long-term chaos. We might encounter regional wars in this process.

SID
Although there seemed to be a domino-like effect between the civil riots in Tunisia, Egypt and Libya, they are very different countries. Tunisia is under French influence, Egypt is an important actor in Arab politics and Libya has a one-man dictatorship. What do you think about the similarities and differences between these countries?

VA
As you mentioned, although the three countries had distinct social and political structures, the uprisings in all of them demanded democracy and enhancement of political participation. However, we also witnessed that the reactions against the uprisings differed in those countries because of their different social and political cultures. For example, the Egyptian opposition movement includes many Christian youth organizations as well as the Muslim Brotherhood, and is supported by the army and bureaucrats. In addition, Egypt had a parliamentarian system since British occupation, which created a population that was accustomed to elections. There were already lots of protests against the government's foreign policy and general strikes in the last 10 years. Therefore, the Egyptian public already had a culture of protest and the government had problems controlling the public. This made it much easier for them to overthrow Mubarak after the Tunisian public managed to overthrow their leader peacefully.

When we look at Tunisia, we see a highly educated country, which has formed close relations with the West, especially with France. However, the opposing views were excluded from the political system as they were in Egypt. The enormity of the young population, increasing economic problems and the government's ignorance to the demands of the public triggered the riot. One other point about Tunisia and Egypt is that the army's support for the uprisings made it impossible for the ruling leaders to resist.

Libya is much different than both Egypt and Tunisia, although it's geographically right in between them. 85% of the population is organized around tribes, and the political power has distributed the administrative power among tribes according to their loyalty to the regime. The Cyrenaica tribes of Eastern Libya were excluded from the political arena in 1969. That created a wide opposition against Qaddafi; the Warfalla, Maslata, Al-Zinta and Abaidat tribes resorted to military means to overthrow Qaddafi. On the other hand, his own tribe as well as Magariha and African tribes supported Qaddafi. Mercenary troops have been formed from the members of these African tribes in Chad. Therefore Libya's problems are different than those of Egypt and Tunisia. The main problem of Libya is the power struggle among tribes. In addition, the international community decided to interfere in the situation in Libya, and it's well possible that the new political structure that will be formed by tribes in Eastern Libya will be recognized by the international community.

SID
The West suggests Turkey, a democratic country whose population is largely Muslim, as a model to the Arab world. What are your thoughts on this issue?

VA
Turkey has developed intense relations with the Middle Eastern countries, and more importantly, the Middle Eastern public in the recent years. Turkish foreign policy regarding the problems in the region has created a positive view of Turkey in the Muslim and Arab world. Turkish television shows became popular in nearly all countries in the region from Morocco to Oman. There is a high level of confidence in Turkey among the public of these countries. This confidence may help Turkey influence the process towards democracy. However each country will have its own struggle shaped by its own social, political and economic conditions. Turkey cannot be a model country, but it can support the Middle Eastern countries with its experience. Cooperation may be possible, especially in the process of institutionalization and development of NGOs. On the other hand, we must admit that Turkey faces many problems with democracy as well, so it may pioneer the movements towards increased democracy in the region with a new Constitution that embraces current global values.

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